



Space Symbols and Agency Acronyms

NATIONAL AERONAUTICS & SPACE ADMINISTRATION

October 1, 2018 marks NASA's 60th anniversary!

The States of NASA

- | | | |
|----------------|------------|--------------|
| 1) California | 4) Alabama | 7) Virginia |
| 2) Texas | 5) Florida | 8) Maryland |
| 3) Mississippi | 6) Ohio | 9) Louisiana |

Bonus: District of Columbia

Did You Know...?

1. C: Your rectangle would be as big as a football field plus end zones.
2. D: The Space Station weighs close to 1 million pounds. Even though it is in space, it isn't weightless because it is still close enough to Earth to feel nearly the full effects of its gravity. Astronauts feel weightless in orbit because the Station's forward speed is fast enough that its path matches the Earth's curvature, even though it is in constant free-fall – a condition that feels weightless because everything in the Station is falling together at the same rate. Cool, huh?
3. B: At its average altitude of about 250 miles, the Space Station needs to go about 17500 miles per hour to stay in orbit – and it sure does!
4. A: Astronauts on board the Space Station go around the Earth once every 90 minutes (an hour-and-a-half) or so, and therefore see a sunrise (and a sunset!) every 90 minutes as well. While it is true that the sun is always shining in space, the fact that the Station is going around the Earth means that its view of the sun is blocked by the Earth during part of each orbit, so each trip around the Earth has a daytime and a night-time.
5. D: The first piece of the Space Station was launched by Russia in 1998.
6. A: In a seemingly 'weightless' environment such as the Space Station has, the spine relaxes, so you – as an on-board guest – would 'grow' taller! (You'd 'shrink' back to your usual height once back on Earth – sorry!)